

About Audit Execution Standard - (AES)

Understanding Audit Execution Standard

What Is Audit Execution Standard?

Audit Execution Standard is the sixth Parent Standard of ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™. It governs how audits are objectively, consistently, transparently, and repeatably executed using objectively verified evidence.

Audit Execution Standard recognizes that verified evidence alone does not produce reliable audit outcomes. A standardized audit methodology is required to evaluate evidence consistently, apply governance requirements objectively, document audit activities, and ensure that audit conclusions are repeatable and independently verifiable.

Canonical Definition

Audit Execution Standard defines the governance conditions required to execute audits using objectively verified evidence. It establishes audit execution principles, execution methodology, procedural controls, governance mechanisms, execution validation, and continuous execution assurance necessary to ensure that audits are performed consistently, transparently, objectively, and in accordance with established governance requirements throughout the complete lifecycle of a governed entity.

Why Audit Execution Standard Exists

Even perfectly verified evidence can produce inconsistent audit results if different auditors apply different methods.

Organizations require a standardized methodology that governs how audits are planned, performed, documented, reviewed, and completed. This ensures that audit outcomes are based on governed procedures rather than individual judgment.

Audit Execution Standard exists to establish a consistent, transparent, and repeatable methodology for executing audits across all operational domains.

What Audit Execution Standard Governs

Audit Execution Standard governs:

- Audit execution
 - Audit procedures
 - Audit methodology
 - Audit activities
 - Execution consistency
 - Execution governance
 - Execution assurance
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Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An organization performs a governance audit of an autonomous AI platform using verified operational evidence collected throughout the AI lifecycle.

Application

Audit Execution Standard governs how auditors execute the audit using standardized procedures, documented methodology, objective evaluation criteria, and governed execution controls.

Result

The audit is performed consistently, transparently, and repeatably, producing reliable findings supported by verified evidence.

Use Case 2 — Regulatory Compliance Audit

Scenario

A regulatory authority conducts a formal compliance audit of a critical infrastructure operator.

Application

Audit Execution Standard governs every stage of audit execution, including evidence evaluation, audit procedures, documentation, governance controls, and execution validation.

Result

The regulatory audit follows a standardized methodology that produces objective, repeatable, and independently verifiable audit outcomes.

Architectural Position

Audit Execution Standard represents the sixth governed space within ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™, transforming objectively verified evidence into a governed audit process before audit findings are established.

Governance Flow

Audit Observation → Evidence Formation → Evidence Integrity → Evidence Correlation → Evidence Verification → Audit Execution → Audit Findings → Audit Response → Audit Preservation → Audit Assurance

Canonical Closing Statement

Audit Execution Standard establishes the canonical governance framework for executing governed audits using objectively verified evidence. By governing audit methodology, execution procedures, governance controls, execution validation, and continuous execution assurance, Audit Execution Standard enables reliable audit, operational reconstruction, accountable governance, and independent verification across all operational domains.

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